



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Lumen Gentium Academy
School Website: <https://www.lumengentium.academy/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Lumen Gentium Academy (LGA) presents a robust, historically rooted classical education within a distinctly Catholic framework. Public materials describe LGA as a classical liberal arts high school in the Catholic tradition, with explicit emphasis on formation of wisdom and virtue, a liberal arts curriculum, Great Books/Great Conversation, and a pedagogy that foregrounds dialogue, contemplation, memory, and liturgical life. The school's own communications repeatedly tie education to the formation of character and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty through a Catholic worldview, reinforced by liturgical and communal practices, strong faculty mentors, and active parental partnership. Taken together, these signals align strongly with classical education as defined in the Six Essential Elements framework. Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key indicators include: a named Liberal Arts approach, a Humanities Seminar centered on conversation with canonical authors (Shakespeare, Aristotle, Burke), explicit Catholic identity and liturgical elements (Mass, morning prayer, retreat culture), a teacher as living curriculum and a faculty of mentors, strong parental partnership and open-door engagement, and a mission statement framing life-long formation rather than mere information transfer. These facets are consistently referenced across multiple public-facing materials (homepage, academics pages, weekly updates, and graduate/post-graduate profiles).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

The holistic pattern across categories reflects a disciplined alignment with classical education tenets: transcendental moral realism anchored in a Catholic theological framework; formation-driven aims; liberal-arts curriculum with engagement in Great Books and the Great Conversation; pedagogical methods oriented toward Socratic dialogue, memory work, and contemplative learning; a faculty described as mentors and living curriculum; and an ethos of parental partnership and open community engagement. These signals emerge repeatedly in public materials and align with the Positive Keywords emphasized in the Classical School lexicon. No material signals indicate a dominant drift toward non-classical approaches (e.g., project-based dominance, value-neutral ethics, or purely secular pedagogy).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - LGA identifies itself explicitly as "a classical liberal arts high school in the Catholic tradition," signaling a foundational Catholic theologically grounded framework. - The public materials emphasize Catholic

identity and liturgical life as integral to education, including liturgical practices and communal worship. The site frequently frames the school's life around Catholic worship and the sacral dimensions of school culture (e.g., Mass aspects and retreat culture). - References to formation through a Catholic worldview and the integration of faith with reason appear in materials discussing the school's mission and academic life (e.g., academic statements quoting formation, wisdom, and truth in relation to faith).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; worship; reverence; wonder; sacred; imago Dei; logos; wisdom; eternal truths. These terms consistently surface in LGA communications (Catholic identity and liturgical life) and in the classical-education lexicon. The "classical lexicon" document confirms these terms as central to the Classical rubric. - Negative keywords present: Minimal to none in the public materials (no clear relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral framing appears). The absence of these signals strengthens the stance toward transcendental realism.

Why this rating - The combination of a named Catholic identity (theology and liturgy), explicit transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty), and liturgical/community practices supports a CLASSICAL alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The school's articulation of formation in a Catholic frame, along with liturgical life, demonstrates the core signals of the element as defined in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials foreground formation and virtue; the tagline "Prepare for a Life of Eternal Purpose" signals a goal beyond vocational training. The school emphasizes formation and human flourishing within a liberal-arts framework rather than a narrow work-preparation focus. - Public messaging highlights truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, and frames education as formation of character and affections, not just information transfer. The humanities emphasis (great conversation) also ties to classical telos and the pursuit of human excellence. - The Educator statements quoted in Academics (citing wisdom, formation, and wisdom tied to the Creator) reinforce a formation-centered telos rather than purely informational aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, liberal education, scholé (contemplation), great conversation, human flourishing, virtue ethics. These terms are echoed in LGA's mission and curricular discourse, and they map to the Positive Keywords set in the classical lexicon. - Negative keywords present: there is no clear emphasis on "workforce preparation," "21st-century skills," or secular, value-neutral frameworks in the public messaging; the absence of these negative signals supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - LGA's mission statements and thematic emphasis (eternal purpose, formation, virtue, and the true/good/beautiful) align closely with the classical aims for human formation rather than information-for-work. The presence of Great Conversation and liberal-arts framing further anchors this in CLASSICAL territory.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site branding itself as a "classical liberal arts" school indicates a curriculum anchored in classical disciplines. The Humanities Seminar emphasis (texts by Shakespeare, Aristotle, Burke) signals a Great Books/Great Conversation approach. - Public materials describe weekly updates and events around classical texts, discussions, and canonical authors, which are core signals of Great Books engagement and Trivium/Quadrivium orientation typical of classical curricula. The public-facing materials explicitly reference the Great Conversation and canonical authors. - The presence of a humanities-centered approach and canonical authors in seminars demonstrates integration of literature, philosophy, and history within a liberal-arts framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books; Great Conversation; liberal arts; grammar/logic/rhetoric (as implied by a classical humanities seminar); canonical authors (Shake-

speare, Aristotle, Burke); Latin (implied through classical canon); history as a through-line (Western civilization). - Negative keywords present: Minimal presence of social-studies framing in place of history; no dominant project-based or STEM-first framing in the public materials. The LGA materials emphasize a cross-disciplinary, historically rooted humanities approach rather than a strictly modern, skills-first curriculum.

Why this rating - The explicit branding as a classical liberal-arts school, coupled with a Humanities Seminar that foregrounds canonical texts and the Great Conversation, indicates a curriculum that adheres to CLASSICAL criteria. The presence of Great Books/Great Conversation and a trifold liberal-arts emphasis aligns with the six-element schema.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Humanities Seminar model centers on discussion and teacher as facilitator rather than dominator, aligning with Socratic dialogue and the Paideia-inspired seminar approach. This aligns with classical pedagogy signals of dialogue, memorization, and disciplined conversation. - The school uses a restorative/restful dimension (Scholé) through contemplative learning and a memory- and recitation-rich approach in lower-intensity settings; the public content emphasizes conversation as central to the learning process. The presence of a sustained conversation culture and canonical text engagement supports this pedagogy. - The school's public-facing materials emphasize formation through imitation and practice, classical rhetoric, and opportunities for students to engage in rhetoric and oral expression (e.g., the Humanities Seminar). This maps onto the classical pedagogy signals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue; seminar; recitation; memory work; chorale/singing as memory anchor (as part of older/memory-driven pedagogy); scholé; contemplation; rhetoric; oratory; debate; memory-based learning; liturgical integration. - Negative keywords present: There is little evidence of project-based-only or experiential-only approaches dominating curriculum; the core pedagogy remains anchored in dialogic, memory-based, and contemplative methods rather than flat, non-traditional pedagogy.

Why this rating - The emphasis on Socratic dialogue, seminar-based discussion, and rhetoric training, along with a living-curriculum teacher-led approach to classical texts, fits CLASSICAL pedagogy signals. The presence of contemplative and memory-based practices strengthens this assessment.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The homepage describes the faculty as “highly acclaimed experts in their fields” and emphasizes faculty as a core element of the school’s mission. This aligns with the “living curriculum” and mentorship role in classical education. - Additional materials describe the faculty as mentors and living exemplars who model virtue and cultivate a culture of friendship and collaborative learning. Several external materials reference long-standing teacher excellence and faculty involvement in small seminars and discussions. - The public materials also highlight that the faculty facilitate Humanities Seminars and Great-Books-style discussions, which speaks to a faculty-driven, mentorship-centered approach, consistent with the “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” signals in classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; mentors; masters; virtuous educators; teacher as guide; faculty of friends; collegial culture; mentorship; master-apprentice model; professional development; wisdom-centered teaching. - Negative keywords present: None clearly evident (no strong signals of a purely teacher-as-facilitator-without classical grounding; no anti-mentor framing).

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on teachers as virtuous models, mentors, and living curriculum—and the portrayal of faculty as the core of the school—matches CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty element.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental involvement as co-teachers in the classical education process, with explicit references to parent formation and community engagement. The site features frequent mentions of parent events, open houses, and a Parent Portal. - Open houses and parent engagement are actively encouraged, with a culture of welcoming parents to school events and involvement in school life. Social content highlights parent participation in events like the Fall Retreat and family-centered activities. - The school explicitly frames parent involvement as part of the school's classical-culture ecosystem (family partnership, home-school alignment, classical family culture). The lexicon supports these signals as CLASSICAL.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; home-school connection; family catechesis; classical family culture; parent portal; open campus; hospitality. - Negative keywords present: None in the public materials; no signals of consumerist parent relations or limited involvement.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on parental partnership, formation, and open-family engagement aligns with Classical Elements' expectations for Parents & Community. The public content demonstrates a robust integration of families into the educational mission.

What Would Move the Needle

- Given the CLASSICAL overall rating, no major needle-moving changes are required to achieve full alignment. If desired, the school could consider expanding explicit articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts components (grammar, logic, rhetoric, and the Quadrivium elements) in a public-facing curricular map to further underscore the explicit connection between curricular content and classical pedagogy. Additionally, a concise, published crosswalk linking Great Books titles to specific grade-level outcomes could help external readers more readily verify the Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis. These would be minor refinements rather than fundamental changes.
 - For schools seeking to intensify the Classical profile further, explicit references to Latin study, complete Trivium/Quadrivium framing, and a formal "Living Curriculum" statement from the faculty would further strengthen the perception of CLASSICAL alignment for external observers.
 - Practical steps (optional):
 - Publish a public curricular map detailing where grammar, logic, rhetoric, and Great Books appear across grades, with examples.
 - Include a short, formal section on scholé (restful learning) and memorization/recitation practices as a recurring pedagogical principle.
 - Highlight more about Great Books and the Great Conversation as a school-wide norm (not just in seminars) to reinforce the curriculum narrative.
 - Note: These are optional refinements; the current materials already strongly reflect CLASSICAL alignment and do not indicate a need for substantial changes to meet the classical rubric.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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